FREE / PLANNING TOOLKIT 01

The Space Makeover Starter Checklist

Turn a renovation idea into a useful project brief, a safer conversation with contractors and a more considered design plan.

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> **Educational planning only.** This checklist is not a construction permit, licensed design, engineering review or instruction to perform regulated work. Rules vary by region.

01 / Define your goal

☐ Photograph the space from one fixed position and take close-up photos of defects.

☐ Record width, depth, heights, door clearance, access paths and any mobility needs.

☐ Write the intended use, three must-haves, preferred visual style and budget range.

☐ Identify the owner, building management or homeowners association to contact.

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02 / Inspect before decorating

☐ Document water leaks, corrosion, cracking, rot, movement and loose railings; seek professional assessment.

☐ Ask which works require planning permission, building permits, inspections and approved contractors.

☐ Check relevant electrical, plumbing, drainage and waterproofing conditions with qualified trades.

☐ Do not conceal defects or assume a decorative refurbishment makes a structurally unsafe area safe.

03 / Scope the job by stage

- ☐ Survey and concept brief; verify site measurements and constraints.
- ☐ Professional designs, approvals, quotations and schedule before construction.
- ☐ Protect neighbouring areas; remove agreed nonstructural finishes safely.
- ☐ Complete approved repairs and regulated building services, then arrange required inspections.
- ☐ Prepare substrates, waterproofing, finishes, fittings and furnishing.
- ☐ Inspect completed work, document defects and retain warranties and product information.

04 / Compare contractors

- ☐ Ask for written inclusions, exclusions, milestones and a proposed schedule.
- ☐ Ask who will secure permits, undertake regulated work and arrange inspections.
- ☐ Ask what product systems, compatibility guidance and manufacturer instructions apply.
- ☐ Request insurance, qualifications, warranties, waste removal and snagging arrangements.

05 / Budget and purchasing

- ☐ Obtain local quotations for labour, materials, design services, permits and disposal.
- ☐ Allow for hidden defects and a sensible contingency; do not rely on generic online rates.
- ☐ Confirm lead times, dimensions, technical data sheets and installation dependencies.
- ☐ Track quote, supplier, amount, due date, payment and warranty for each item.

Project notes

Space / address: ____

Budget range: ____

Authorities and permits to confirm: ______________________________

Contractor / designer: ____

Open questions and next actions: ______________________________